PART 4 · MODULE E

Freelancing for developers: packages, discovery, proposals, pricing and delivery

How to sell development work once you can build it.

E1. Service packages you can offer

Package the work so the client can compare options. Prices depend on your region, experience and the client's market; no price here is a market rate.

Package	What the client gets	Illustrative scope (not market data)
Landing page	One responsive page, contact form, basic SEO, analytics	A single page with 3 to 5 sections
Business website	Up to 5 pages, CMS or easy editing, performance and accessibility checks	Brochure site with a contact and enquiry form
E-commerce store	Store setup, product import, payment test and live, shipping and tax set-up checked against official rules	Shopify or WooCommerce store with a product list
Maintenance	Monthly updates, backups, security checks, small edits, a monthly report	Ongoing service billed monthly
Custom application	Requirements, design, build, testing, deployment, handover	Booking, portal or dashboard project priced by milestone

E2. Client discovery

Ask about goals, users, content, deadlines and success measures before you quote. Write the answers down; they become your scope.

TEXT

```
Discovery call script (20 minutes)
1. Open: 'Thanks for your time. I will ask a few questions, then suggest what fits.'
2. Goal: 'What must the website achieve in the next 3 months?'
3. Users: 'Who visits, and what do they need to do?'
4. Content: 'What do you already have: text, photos, logo?'
5. Constraints: 'What is your deadline and budget range?'
6. Success: 'How will we know it worked?'
7. Close: 'I will send a short proposal by [day]. Shall we confirm the next step?'
```

E3. Proposal writing

A good proposal states the outcome, what is included, what is not, the timeline, the price, payment terms and the assumptions. A complete example:

TEXT

```
Subject: Proposal: responsive landing page for Asha's Bakery

Hello Asha,

Thank you for the brief. Here is what I propose.
```

```
What I will build
- A one-page responsive site with your menu, opening hours and an order form.
- Form checks for phone numbers, and an email to you when an order arrives.
- Accessibility and speed checks on mobile and desktop, with the results shared.

Timeline
- Day 1-2: confirm content and photos.
- Day 3-5: design and build, with one preview link for your feedback.
- Day 6: final changes (two rounds of revisions are included), launch and handover.

Price (fixed)
- Rs [amount], including hosting for the first year as set out in the agreement.
- Payment: 50% to start, 50% on launch.

Assumptions: you provide the text and photos; any third-party costs are shown before you pay.

I can start on [date] once the deposit is received. Happy to answer any questions.

[Your name] | [phone] | [portfolio link]
```

E4. Pricing

Three simple methods, with example arithmetic (illustrative numbers only):

- **Hourly:** estimated hours × hourly rate. Example: 30 hours × Rs 800 = Rs 24,000 (illustrative).
- **Fixed:** price the scope, add a buffer for revisions. Example: Rs 24,000 scope + 15% revision buffer = Rs 27,600.
- **Retainer:** a monthly fee for a defined amount of work, for maintenance. Example: 4 hours a month at Rs 800 plus hosting, illustrative only.

Include software and hosting costs in the quote, and say which subscriptions the client pays for directly. Do not state earnings or income guarantees to clients or students.

E5. Delivery and handover

Deliver to a staging link, get written approval, launch, then hand over: login details (through a password manager, never plain text), a one-page guide, backup and update notes, and the support period.

E6. Post-project support

Offer a fixed support window (for example 14 days for bugs) and a paid maintenance plan after it. Record every change request in writing.

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